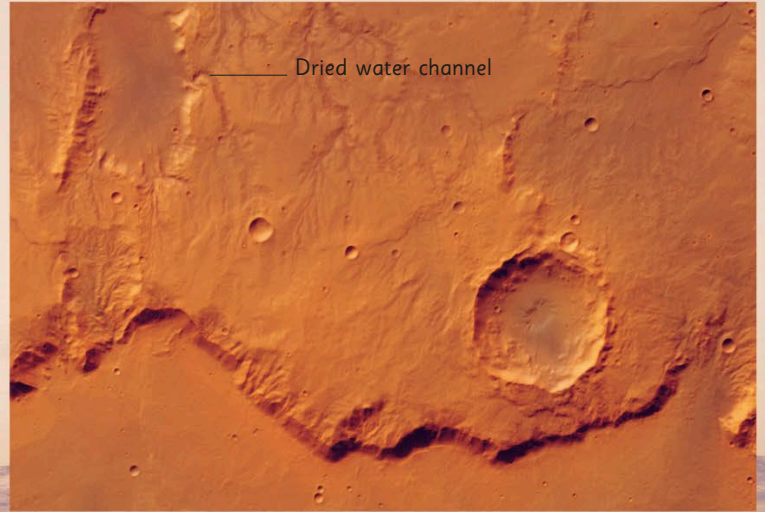


Is there water?

Mars is such a cold planet that its water is mostly in the form of ice. However, dried up water channels and lakes tell us huge amounts of liquid water flowed over Mars in the past. Downhill streaks seen in 2015 were formed by very recent water flows.



Dried water channel

A face on Mars

In 1976, *Viking 1 Orbiter* sent a series of shots that showed a “face” on the planet’s surface. Many saw this as an enormous sculpture built by intelligent life. It’s actually a mountain.



Recent picture of the “face”.



The first blurry picture of the “face”.

That’s definitely Martian!

There are a number of notable features on the surface of Mars.



The planet experiences strong winds that create immense **dust storms**.



The **Olympus Mons volcano** is the largest in the solar system.



Mars has two **polar ice caps** – one at its south pole and one at its north pole.



The **Valles Marineris canyon** would stretch across the USA.

... (24 Earth hours, 39 minutes, and a few seconds).